

From: Dean of Students deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie 
Subject: Re: Thanks for the Notice, what about the complaint submitted first? Re: Notice of Temporary Suspension and Support under QA269
Date: 25 September 2024 at 10:29
To: MAC LIATHÁIN, CIAN C.MACLIATHAIN2@universityofgalway.ie

Dear Cian,

Thank you for taking time to set out your response to the notice about a temporary suspension and support, invoked under QA269. I have shared this also with the review panel that will meet you as part of the QA269 stage three process, so that they are aware of your feedback. There will also be further opportunities for you to comment, once the chair of the panel has been in contact with you. Full details about the stage 3 process can be found in appendix 4 of the attached document.

In the meantime, below are responses to some of your questions.

You were asked not to include other email addresses in your correspondence with this Office. I have removed Maeve McCaldin from my reply. I would ask you to adhere to this request in any future emails. Please note, the typical response time from my Office is three working days.

Please remember, Cian, this suspension is a temporary measure, taken with a view to the duty of care owed to both yourself and the University community. We want to work with you.

All best wishes,
Ciara

1. **Do I still have access to student service like free legal aid?** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
2. **Did I threaten anyone or claim to be aggressive or self-harming?** Details of concerns that caused the temporary suspension and support under QA269 to be invoked have been recorded in a 'note of concern' that will be shared with you by the review panel as part of the stage 3 process. I have re-attached the policy, sent in my email of 20 September, for ease of access.
3. **Your concerns for my wellbeing are unwarranted. I am not in crisis, what gave you that impression?** As above.
4. **What serious grounds, can you elaborate to me were deemed serious or concerning? Did I clog your IMAP servers?** As above.
5. **I will retain full right to contact my Disability Advisor Maeve McCaldin, though?** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
6. **How is this review panel arranged, do any of them know me personally? You drew a false conclusion I believe.** Membership of the review panel is set out in Appendix 4, section 2 'Membership' (attached). Here is the relevant extract:

The Review Panel shall be constituted as follows:

- Chairperson, appointed by the President or Designated Authority
- Academic Secretary, or nominee, as secretary to the panel
- Three members, selected by the Registrar & Deputy President, from the panel nominated by the Academic Council
- Two student representatives, normally members of the Student Union Executive.

7. **Am I free to access the Student Emergency Fund? I receive Disability Allowance for my perfectly self-managed anxiety / trauma / identity disorder.** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
8. **Have plenty pdfs of references from those more expert than me in terms of psychological or educational claims of mine.** You will be invited to submit any relevant documentation to the review panel in advance of the meeting.
9. **And how many representatives can I bring to this review panel? Maeve McCaldin, Kathy O'Sullivan and Cornelia Connolly please.** As per Appendix 4, section 4.3 of QA269 (attached): 'The student may be accompanied at the meeting by a Students' Union representative, a fellow student or family member or others as appropriate. Students with a disability may also be accompanied by a support worker where required'.
10. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother and younger siblings, represent myself, I repeat am not at risk... what counter information and from whom are you claiming I deserve suspension?** As per Appendix 4, section 4.2 of QA269 (attached): 'The student will be invited in writing to attend and given at least 7 days' notice of the Review Meeting and informed of the purpose of the meeting. They will also be provided with copies of any documents, which will be considered in the meeting'
11. **If I wrote this email in my mother tongue of Gaeilge would you find that more misconstruingly offensive?** You are welcome to correspond with me as Gaeilge.
12. **You were quick to send me this suspension, what about a reply for the valid complaint I've already submitted to NUIG following your complaints process?** I have consulted with the Students' Union on your complaint as SULT is operated by the SU, not University of Galway. The SU has confirmed that security working at SULT are not University of Galway employees, which means that I am not in a position to progress the complaint in its current form. The SU, however, can investigate the complaint. With your complaint, I can officially forward your complaint to them.
13. **Let me make a list of all the above questions to simplify your reply, it is my right as a BME graduate to require you to reply to each one as that is what a teacher does, no?** Queries will be answered within a reasonable timeframe.

14. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother**

14. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother and younger siblings, represent myself, I repeat am not at risk... what counter information and from whom are you claiming I deserve suspension?** Answered above.
15. **If I wrote this email in my mother tongue of Gaeilge would you find that more misconstruingly offensive?** Answered above.
16. **You were quick to send me this suspension, what about a reply for the valid complaint I've already submitted to NUIG following your complaints process?** Answered above.
17. **What serious grounds, can you elaborate to me were deemed serious or concerning? Did I clog your IMAP servers?** Answered above.
18. **I will retain full right to contact my Disability Advisor Maeve McCaldin, though?** Answered above.
19. **I am a remote student, I live safe and sound in Belfast, your suspension and suggestion of myself from physically attending the campus is rather irrelevant and misinterpretation of my written text is not my prerogative – English is my second language. What makes you think your concerns are warranted?** Details of concerns that caused the temporary suspension and support under QA269 to be invoked have been recorded in a 'note of concern' that will be shared with you by the review panel as part of the stage 3 process.

Prof Ciara Meehan (she/her)

Déan na Mac Léinn | Dean of Students

Oifig Déan na Mac Léinn
Office of the Dean of Students



OLLSCOIL NA GAILLIMHE
UNIVERSITY OF GALWAY

University
ofGalway.ie

Uimhir Carthanachta Cláraithe/Registered Charity Number 20002107

From: MAC LIATHÁIN, CIAN <C.MACLIATHAIN2@universityofgalway.ie>
Sent: 20 September 2024 18:07
To: Dean of Students <deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>
Cc: McCaldin, Maeve <maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>
Subject: Thanks for the Notice, what about the complaint submitted first? Re: Notice of Temporary Suspension and Support under QA269

Your concerns for my wellbeing are unwarranted. I am not in crisis, what gave you that impression?

Staff members I emailed regarding ongoing educational issues I am experiencing know me quite well, or may remember me better if they read my previous assignments or their previous feedback to me.

I am a remote student, I live safe and sound in Belfast, your suspension and suggestion of myself from physically attending the campus is rather irrelevant and misinterpretation of my written text is not my prerogative – English is my second language. What makes you think your concerns are warranted? I am emancipated from my family, and am free to answer any direct questions, in writing obviously, for my protection.

Any and all emails I sent previously, could be replied to asking for further clarification of why it was sent and CCed to educator obliged to support a star student of the Bachelor of Mathematics & Education.

At no point was I advised not to email lecturers relevant to my current and future education. Do you think me delusional, grandiose for having the courage to speak out about the below:

I was previously an inpatient of one Professor Colm McDonald.

His conflict of interest was identified to him previously as he was a lecturer to my famous older brother Craig Mac Liatháin who claimed I had psychosis when I told him that I was diagnosed with an anxiety disorder and Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder by one Dr James McLaughlin.

He thought this was a psychotic break because my stepfather is called James O Loughlin.

I identified Professor McDonald's conflict of interest and his successive denial of this lead to him accidentally or purposefully committing malpractice at my expense. He out of spite prescribed increasing doses of brain damaging neuroleptics (a chemical proven by Dr Peter Breggin's work and origination in relation to Auschwitz (Models of Madness, forgot year) later publications regarding the efficacy of medical marijuana in opposition to this. Those fraudulently prescribed neuroleptics have been out of my system for 6 months and I'm doing quite well thank you despite a need for a prescription to ventolin, protopic and medical marijuana which is in progress here in the United Kingdom.

I was the victim of multiple assaults here in Belfast but am receiving physical care from the NHS, multiple hits to the head and exacerbation of my previous spinal damage. Also false allegations from staff members of Queen's University Belfast when I followed their official complaints procedure advising them of a bouncer and a disability advisor who committed educational prejudice and a hate crime.

I am registered with your Disability Office with CPTSD and anxiety disorder.

Your insinuation that I am in crisis and suspended to await

Professor Meehan, I have submitted a valid complaint previously against NUIG Security for assaults on my body occurring in Summer 2019 by Security + Gardaí and

Security for assaults on my body occurring in Summer 2019 by Security / Garda and also in Summer 2023 by the bouncer of Sult / College Bar.

I am not in crisis.

Did I threaten anyone or claim to be aggressive or self-harming?

With all due respect, Professor Michelle Millar – the previous Dean of Students was very supportive of me when I was previously homeless for 6 months.

I have further evidence to my claims, safety and clean bill of mental health something which I manage quite well via bibliotherapy and the entourage effect of legal CBD herb.

I am rather educated by virtue of the inspiring lectures that granted me my Bachelor in Arts of Mathematics and Education (educational psychology, sociology,, my Higher Diploma in Software Design and Development and my Dioplóma sa Ghaeilge (C1) where I received first-class honours in each.

Your sudden suspension without clarifying questions is educationally biased and severely traumatising to insinuate I am a risk to other on campus in the first never mind remotely from Belfast? Do you find that question offensive? I thought the Dean of Students was obligated to protect students and promote them to feel a sense of safety

The President doesn't know me, if you have misinterpreted any previous emails, feel free to forward them back to me and ask why I sent it to whom when?

Mise le meas díoma agus mífhoighne leis an false allegation of threats to safety to myself or others,

Cian Mac Liatháin Uí Dhéisigh

Cian Lyons Deacy, the Deacy's whom Terryland Park was named after when my uncle died and their heritage as part of the tribe of Morris of Galway.

P.S.

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From: Dean of Students <deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>

Date: Friday, 20 September 2024 at 14:24

To: MAC LIATHÁIN, CIAN <C.MACLIATHAIN2@universityofgalway.ie>

Subject: Notice of Temporary Suspension and Support under QA269

**For the attention of Cian Mac Liatháin (11476078)
 Notice of Temporary Suspension and Support under QA269 Support for
 Students in Crisis Policy**

Dear Cian,

I am writing to inform you that the President, Professor Peter McHugh, having

consulted as appropriate, is of the opinion that there are sufficiently serious grounds for concerns about your behaviour and well-being, as exhibited through your extensive and repeated emails to staff, to invoke an immediate temporary suspension under Section 9 and Appendix 5 of QA269 Support for Students in Crisis policy (please see attached).

This is a temporary measure, taken with a view to the duty of care owed to both yourself and the University community. The decision has been exercised with due regard to natural justice and fair procedure.

Please note, this temporary suspension shall not be regarded as an indication as to whether or not the grounds for concern is proven.

Next Steps

- In my capacity as Dean of Students, I will now invoke Stage 3 of QA269 Support for Students in Crisis policy, and a review panel will engage with you to determine the supports necessary.
- The time period for the suspension has not yet been determined. This will be assessed by the review panel.
- We will endeavour to move as expeditiously as possible to arrange a meeting of the review panel. We do not expect there to be a lengthy wait, but we will need to follow the steps outlined in the policy (attached).
- In line with Appendix 5, point 6 of the policy, every reasonable effort will be made to support you to continue your academic studies:
 - You may continue to engage with those aspects of your course where materials are available on Canvas, including pre-recorded lectures.
 - You shall not attend the live lectures, campus-based activities, or engage with the discussion board elements of the course.
- Throughout your suspension, you are not permitted to physically access the campus.
- Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only. Other emails should not be copied into the correspondence. Should this not be respected, the University will have to take measures to temporarily restrict your email access. Reasonable response times apply.
- Throughout your suspension, you retain the right to access University of Galway Student Counselling Service. Sessions can be delivered online. Should you wish to avail of this service, please email deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie and the Office of the Dean of Students will make the arrangements.

The University will notify you of next steps in due course having regard to the requirements of the QA269 Support for Students in Crisis policy.

Regards,

Ciara

Prof Ciara Meehan (she/her)
Déan na Mac Léinn | Dean of Students

Oifig Déan na Mac Léinn
Office of the Dean of Students



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